

User Manual

Web-Based Vehicle Auction Platform

Prepared for TaproJapan Co. Ltd.

1. Introduction

This manual explains how to use the Web-Based Vehicle Auction Platform. It is written for three types of readers: Guests browsing the public catalogue, registered Buyers who place bids, and Administrators who manage vehicles, auctions, and user accounts. Each section below is organised around a specific task, and screenshots are provided to show exactly what you will see on screen.

1.1 Who This Manual Is For

Reader	Relevant Sections
Guest (not logged in)	Sections 3, 4.1 – 4.5
Registered Buyer	Sections 3, 4.1 – 4.9, 6
Administrator	Sections 3, 5.1 – 5.5, 6

1.2 Accessing the System

The platform is accessed through any modern web browser (Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Microsoft Edge, or Safari). No installation is required. Enter the system's web address in the browser's address bar to open the vehicle catalogue.

Recommended screen resolution: 1280 × 720 or higher for the best layout on the admin dashboard. The site is also usable on mobile phones and tablets.

2. User Roles Overview

The system defines three levels of access. A visitor's capabilities expand as they register and are verified by an administrator.

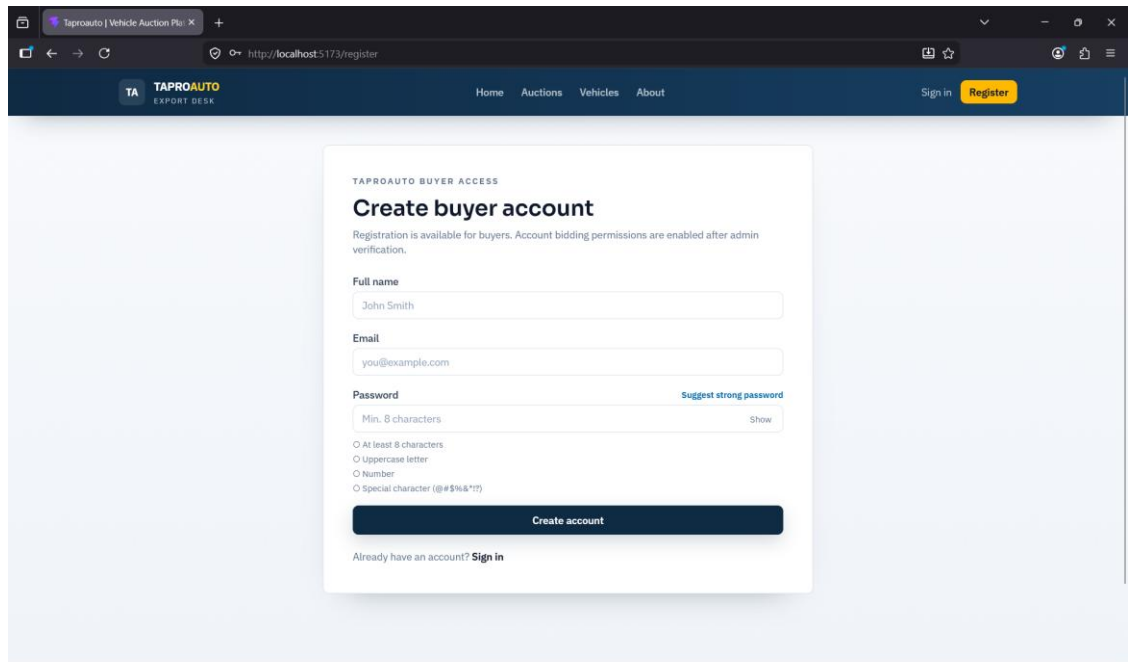
Role	How Obtained	Capabilities
Guest	No action needed — default for any visitor	Browse the vehicle catalogue and auctions; view bid history and winner pages
Buyer (unverified)	Self-registration at the Register page	All Guest capabilities; cannot place bids until verified by an administrator
Buyer (verified)	Approved by an administrator after registration	All Guest capabilities plus placing bids on active auctions
Administrator	Created only by the system owner (not self-service)	Full control: manage vehicles, auctions, and users; verify buyers; close auctions and select winners

3. Getting Started

3.1 Creating an Account

New buyers must register before they can bid. Follow these steps:

1. Open the platform in your browser and click Register in the top navigation bar.
2. Fill in your full name, email address, and a password.
3. Click Create Account.
4. You will be redirected to the Login page with a confirmation message that your account was created.

A screenshot of a web browser showing the 'Create buyer account' form on the Taproauto platform. The browser's address bar shows 'http://localhost:5173/register'. The page has a dark blue header with the Taproauto logo and navigation links: Home, Auctions, Vehicles, About, Sign in, and a yellow Register button. The main content area is light blue and contains a white registration form. The form is titled 'TAPROAUTO BUYER ACCESS' and 'Create buyer account'. It includes a sub-header 'Registration is available for buyers. Account bidding permissions are enabled after admin verification.' and fields for 'Full name' (with 'John Smith' entered), 'Email' (with 'you@example.com' entered), and 'Password'. The password field has a 'Suggest strong password' link and a 'Show' button. Below the password field are four radio button options: 'Min. 8 characters', 'At least 8 characters', 'Uppercase letter', 'Number', and 'Special character (@#\$%&*!?)'. A dark blue 'Create account' button is at the bottom of the form. Below the button is a link: 'Already have an account? Sign in'.

Note: A newly registered account cannot place bids immediately. An administrator must verify your account first - see Section 4.6.

3.2 Logging In

5. Click Login in the top navigation bar.
6. Enter your registered email address and password.
7. Click Login.

On successful login you are redirected automatically: administrators are taken to the Admin Dashboard, and buyers are taken to the Auctions page.

3.3 Navigating the Homepage

The top navigation bar is visible on every page and provides links to Vehicles, Auctions, and (once logged in) your Profile. Administrators additionally see an Admin link with a red badge showing the number of buyer accounts awaiting verification.

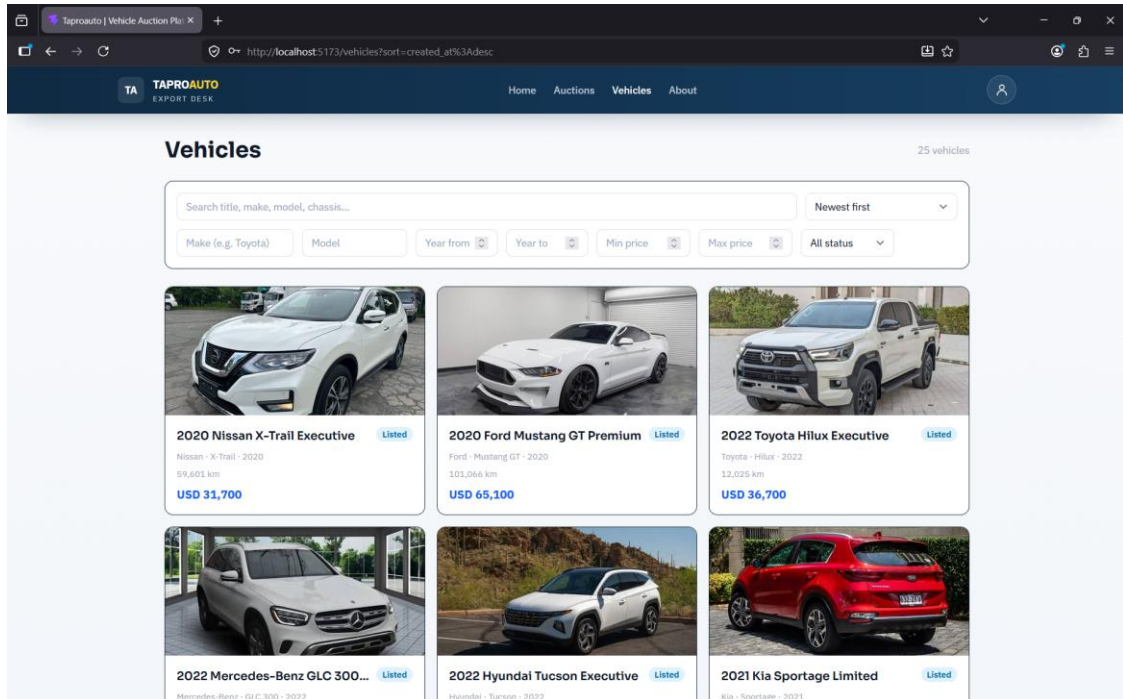
The screenshot shows the Admin Dashboard for Taproauto. The top navigation bar includes links for Home, Auctions, Vehicles, About, and Admin (with a red badge). The Admin Dashboard title is displayed, along with buttons for Reports, + Vehicle, + Auction, and Logout. Below the title, there are tabs for Vehicles, Auctions, and Users. The Vehicles tab is active, showing a table of vehicles with columns for ID, Title / Make Model Year, Starting Price, and Status. The status is 'Listed' for all vehicles. The table includes links for Edit and Delete for each vehicle.

ID	TITLE / MAKE MODEL YEAR	STARTING PRICE	STATUS
6	2020 Nissan X-Trail Executive	USD 31,700	Listed
14	2020 Ford Mustang GT Premium	USD 65,100	Listed
3	2022 Toyota Hilux Executive	USD 36,700	Listed
18	2022 Mercedes-Benz GLC 300 Base	USD 66,100	Listed
11	2022 Hyundai Tucson Executive	USD 34,000	Listed
12	2021 Kia Sportage Limited	USD 36,300	Listed
7	2022 Nissan Navara Executive	USD 37,100	Listed
17	2021 Mercedes-Benz C200 Sport	USD 56,100	Listed
15	2021 BMW 320i Limited	USD 44,900	Listed
9	2020 Mitsubishi Montero Sport Executive	USD 27,800	Listed
20	2021 Audi Q5 Sport	USD 67,300	Listed
22	2023 Tesla Model Y Premium	USD 53,900	Listed
19	2020 Audi A4 Premium	USD 55,700	Listed
25	2021 Porsche Cayenne Limited	USD 98,300	Listed

4. Buyer Features

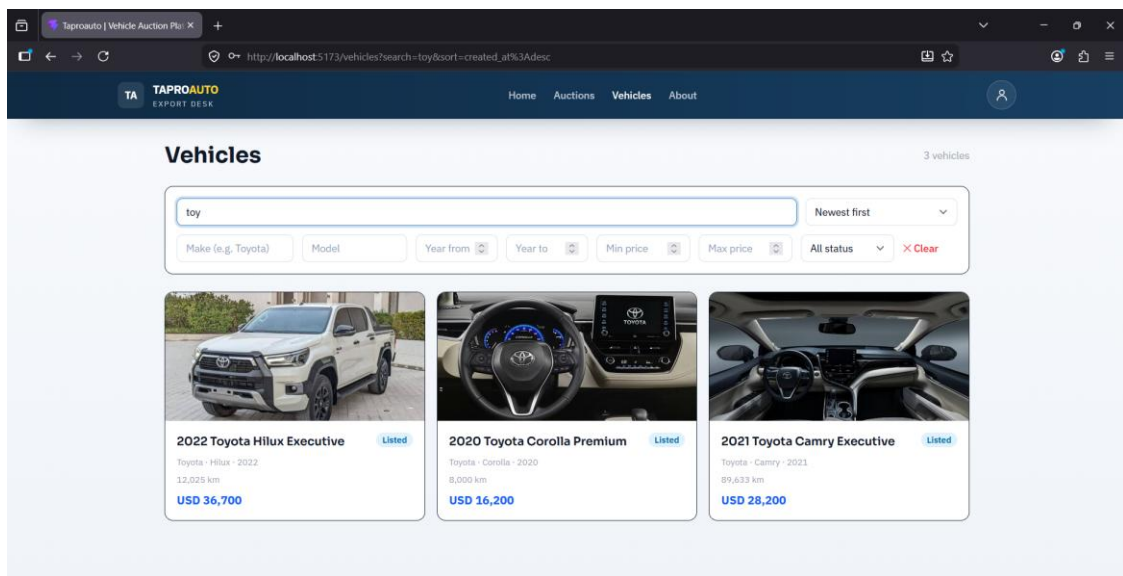
4.1 Browsing the Vehicle Catalogue

The Vehicles page lists all listed vehicles as cards showing a thumbnail image, make, model, year, and starting price. Use the pagination controls at the bottom of the page to move between pages of results.



4.2 Filtering and Searching Vehicles

Use the filter panel at the top of the Vehicles page to narrow results by make, model, year range, and price range. Filters are reflected in the page's web address, so you can bookmark or share a filtered search with someone else.



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Professional vehicle auction access for verified buyers,
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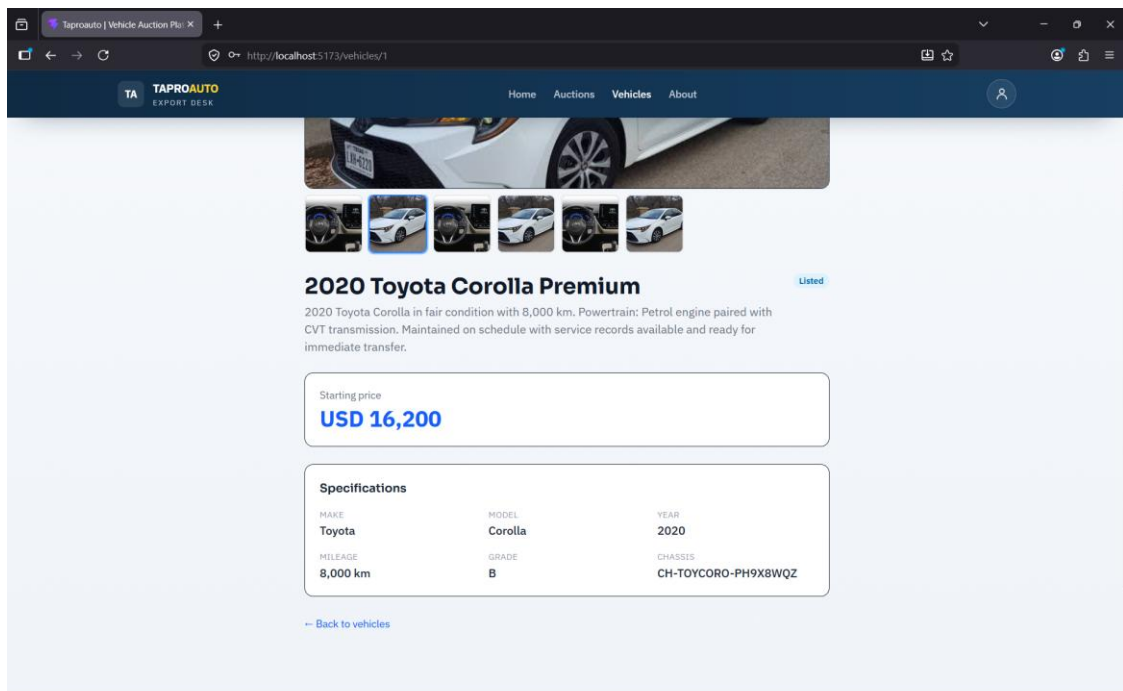
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Contact

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Mon-Fri, 9:00-18:00 JST
+81 3-6426-7620
info@taorolanan.co.jp

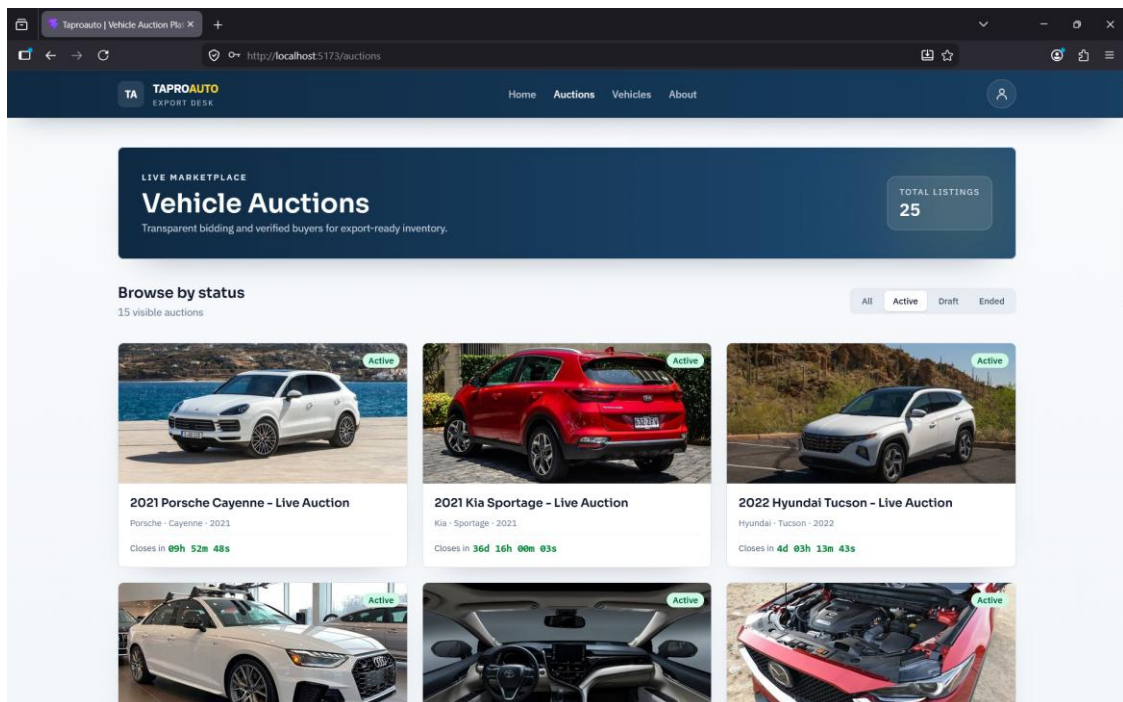
4.3 Viewing Vehicle Details

Click any vehicle card to open its detail page, which shows the full specification (chassis number, mileage, grade), an image gallery, and a link to its associated auction if one exists.



4.4 Browsing Auctions

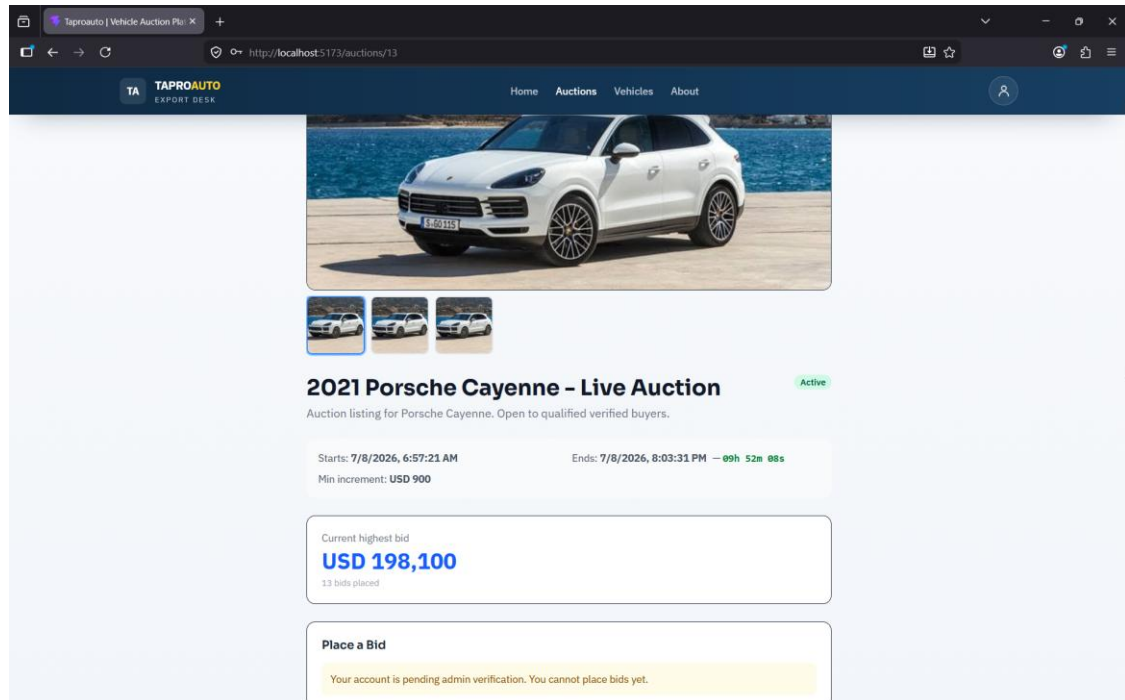
The Auctions page lists all auctions with a status badge (Draft, Active, or Ended) and, for active auctions, a live countdown timer showing the time remaining.



4.5 Viewing Auction Details

Opening an auction shows the vehicle's image gallery (click the main image for a full-screen view; use the arrow keys to move between images and Escape to close), the current highest bid, the full bid history, and a reserve price indicator.

The reserve indicator shows one of three states: no reserve set, reserve not yet met, or reserve met. Buyers see only this indicator; the actual reserve amount is visible to administrators only.



Note: The auction page automatically refreshes bid data every 15 seconds while the auction is active, so you do not need to reload the page to see new bids.

4.6 Account Verification

Before you can place a bid, an administrator must verify your account (see Section 5.4). You can check your verification status at any time on your Profile page. If you log in before your account is verified, log out and log back in after verification so your session reflects the update.

4.7 Placing a Bid

Once verified, a bid form appears at the bottom of any active auction's detail page.

8. Open the detail page of an active auction.
9. Enter a bid amount that is at least the current highest bid plus the minimum increment shown on the page.
10. Click Place Bid.
11. Your bid appears immediately at the top of the bid history table.

The first screenshot shows the 'Place a Bid' form with a message: 'Your account is pending admin verification. You cannot place bids yet.' Below it is the 'Bid History' table.

AMOUNT	BIDDER	PLACED
★ USD 198,100	Jaylan Monahan	7/8/2026, 7:36:23 AM
USD 196,150	Joana Rohan	7/8/2026, 7:08:32 AM
USD 192,300	Nagoya Auto Link	7/8/2026, 8:53:23 AM
USD 181,750	Katrina Cartwright-Schoen	7/8/2026, 7:43:24 AM
USD 166,000	Jacinthe Dickinson	7/8/2026, 8:23:05 AM
USD 159,450	Kobe Trade Cars	7/8/2026, 8:23:19 AM
USD 152,750	Rose Auer	7/8/2026, 8:33:38 AM
USD 148,750	Kobe Trade Cars	7/8/2026, 8:34:06 AM
USD 141,550	Nagoya Auto Link	7/8/2026, 7:38:59 AM
USD 132,050	Ebba Adams	7/8/2026, 7:04:46 AM
USD 122,400	Catherine Graham-Wyman	7/8/2026, 9:50:16 AM
USD 117,000	Rose Auer	7/8/2026, 7:45:47 AM
USD 106,850	Demo Buyer	7/8/2026, 7:23:47 AM

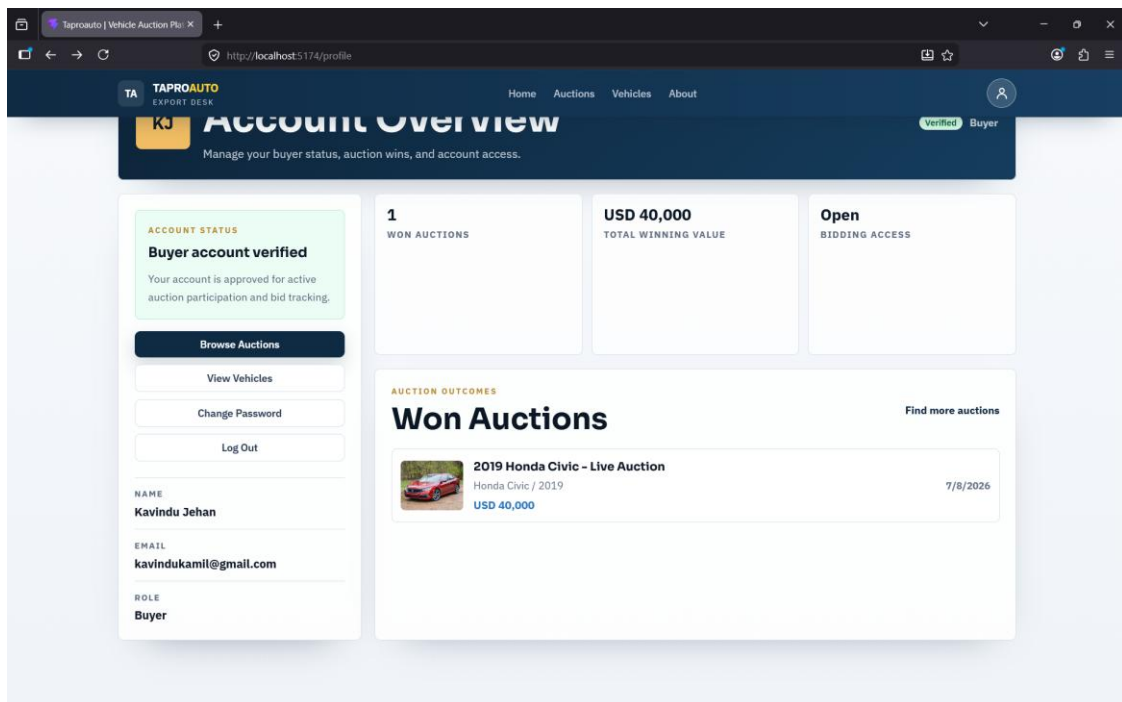
The second screenshot shows the 'Place a Bid' form with a 'Bid' button and a message: 'Bid placed successfully!'. Below it is the 'Bid History' table.

AMOUNT	BIDDER	PLACED
★ USD 40,000	Kavindu Jehan	7/8/2026, 10:27:01 AM
USD 36,800	Verified Importer	7/8/2026, 8:45:55 AM
USD 34,200	Paulette Hickie	7/8/2026, 9:57:55 AM
USD 32,250	Osaka Motor Depot	7/8/2026, 7:43:47 AM
USD 29,350	Verified Importer	7/8/2026, 10:12:52 AM
USD 28,450	Kaden Yundt	7/8/2026, 5:48:43 AM
USD 26,200	Brandi Lakin	7/8/2026, 7:50:57 AM
USD 25,000	Ada Erner	7/8/2026, 9:32:38 AM
USD 22,800	Elbert Rosenbaum	7/8/2026, 6:29:56 AM
USD 21,550	Tony Hilli	7/8/2026, 6:33:53 AM
USD 20,950	Jean Becker	7/8/2026, 3:35:18 AM
USD 20,050	Yokohama Vehicle Hub	7/8/2026, 2:38:46 AM
USD 18,500	Verified Importer	7/8/2026, 8:24:58 AM

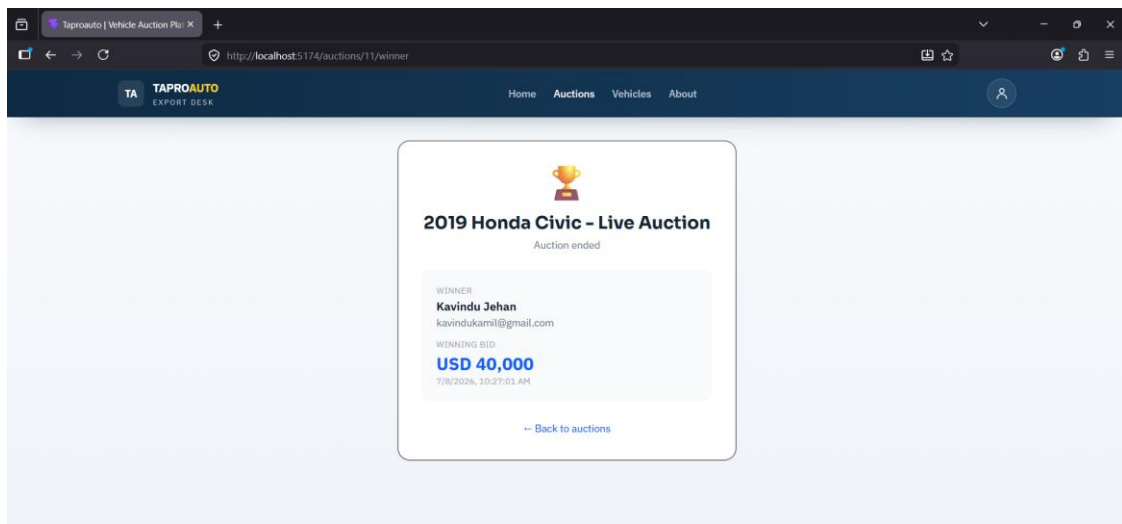
Note: If your bid is below the required minimum, the system rejects it and displays an error message stating the minimum acceptable amount.

4.8 Winning an Auction

When an auction closes, the highest bid is either automatically selected as the winner or confirmed by an administrator. If you win, a green "You Won!" banner appears at the top of the site the next time you visit while logged in. Click the banner's close icon to dismiss it — it will not reappear.



Anyone can view the public Winner page for a closed auction, which shows the winning buyer's name and the winning bid amount.



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info@taprojapan.co.jp

4.9 My Profile

The Profile page shows your account details, current verification status, and a list of auctions you have won, including the winning bid amount for each.

The screenshot shows the 'Account Overview' page for a user named Kavindu Jehan. The page is divided into several sections:

- Client Profile:** Displays the user's name, email, role (Buyer), and verification status (Verified).
- Account Status:** A green box indicating 'Buyer account verified' with a message: 'Your account is approved for active auction participation and bid tracking.'
- Navigation Links:** Buttons for 'Browse Auctions', 'View Vehicles', 'Change Password', and 'Log Out'.
- Summary Cards:** Three cards showing '1 WON AUCTIONS', 'USD 40,000 TOTAL WINNING VALUE', and 'Open BIDDING ACCESS'.
- Won Auctions:** A section titled 'Auction Outcomes' showing a list of won auctions. The first entry is a '2019 Honda Civic - Live Auction' won on 7/8/2026 for USD 40,000.

5. Administrator Features

5.1 Accessing the Admin Dashboard

Log in with an administrator account to be redirected automatically to the Admin Dashboard, available at any time from the Admin link in the navigation bar. The dashboard has three tabs: Vehicles, Auctions, and Users.

The screenshot shows the 'Admin Dashboard' with three tabs: 'Vehicles', 'Auctions', and 'Users'. The 'Vehicles' tab is active, displaying a table of vehicles for sale.

ID	TITLE / MAKE MODEL YEAR	STARTING PRICE	STATUS
1	2020 Toyota Corolla Sport	USD 19,100	Listed
11	2022 Hyundai Tucson Premium	USD 31,000	Listed
14	2020 Ford Mustang GT Premium	USD 67,900	Listed
25	2021 Porsche Cayenne Premium	USD 115,800	Listed
24	2022 Jeep Wrangler Rubicon Executive	USD 70,600	Listed
2	2021 Toyota Camry Executive	USD 22,600	Listed
8	2021 Mazda CX-5 Sport	USD 37,200	Listed
5	2021 Honda CR-V Premium	USD 26,900	Listed
21	2023 Tesla Model 3 Limited	USD 48,700	Listed
17	2021 Mercedes-Benz C200 Limited	USD 47,300	Listed
6	2020 Nissan X-Trail Base	USD 35,100	Listed
18	2022 Mercedes-Benz GLC 300 Sport	USD 81,900	Listed
22	2023 Tesla Model Y Sport	USD 54,800	Listed
3	2022 Toyota Hilux Base	USD 33,200	Listed

5.2 Managing Vehicles

The Vehicles tab lists every vehicle with options to edit or delete each entry, and an Add Vehicle button to create a new listing.

12. Click Add Vehicle (or the edit icon on an existing vehicle).
13. Fill in the title, description, make, model, year, starting price, chassis number, mileage, and grade.
14. Upload one or more images — each is uploaded to the image hosting service immediately and a thumbnail preview appears.
15. Click Save. The vehicle now appears in the public catalogue if its status is Listed.

The screenshot shows the 'Add Vehicle' form in a web browser. The browser address bar shows 'http://localhost:5173/admin/vehicles/new'. The form is titled 'Add Vehicle' and contains the following fields:

- Title ***: Text input with placeholder 'e.g. Toyota Land Cruiser 200'.
- Make ***: Text input with 'Toyota'.
- Model ***: Text input with 'Land Cruiser'.
- Year ***: Text input with '2026'.
- Starting Price (USD) ***: Text input with '5000000'.
- Description ***: Text area with placeholder 'Condition, history, extras...'.
- Status ***: Dropdown menu with 'Draft' selected.
- Chassis Number**: Text input with 'JZX100-0012345'.
- Mileage (km)**: Text input with '85000'.
- Grade**: Text input with '4.5'.
- Images**: Section with a 'Browse...' button and text 'No files selected. Upload multiple images. Hover a thumbnail to remove it.'

At the bottom of the form are two buttons: 'Create Vehicle' (blue) and 'Cancel' (white).

5.3 Managing Auctions

The Auctions tab lists all auctions. Use Add Auction to link a new auction to an existing vehicle, setting a start time, end time, minimum bid increment, and an optional reserve price. Administrators alone can see the actual reserve price amount on the auction detail page.

The screenshot shows the 'Create Auction' form in a web browser. The browser address bar shows 'http://localhost:5173/admin/auctions/new'. The form is titled 'Create Auction' and contains the following fields:

- Vehicle ***: Dropdown menu with '-- select vehicle --'.
- Auction Title (optional)**: Text input with placeholder 'Defaults to vehicle title if blank'.
- Description**: Text area with placeholder 'Any special notes...'.
- Initial Status**: Dropdown menu with 'Draft (not visible to buyers)' selected.
- Starts At**: Date and time input with format 'mm / dd / yyyy, --:-- --'.
- Ends At**: Date and time input with format 'mm / dd / yyyy, --:-- --'.
- Minimum Bid Increment (USD)**: Text input with '0'.
- Reserve Price -- USD (hidden from buyers)**: Text input with placeholder 'Leave blank for no reserve'.

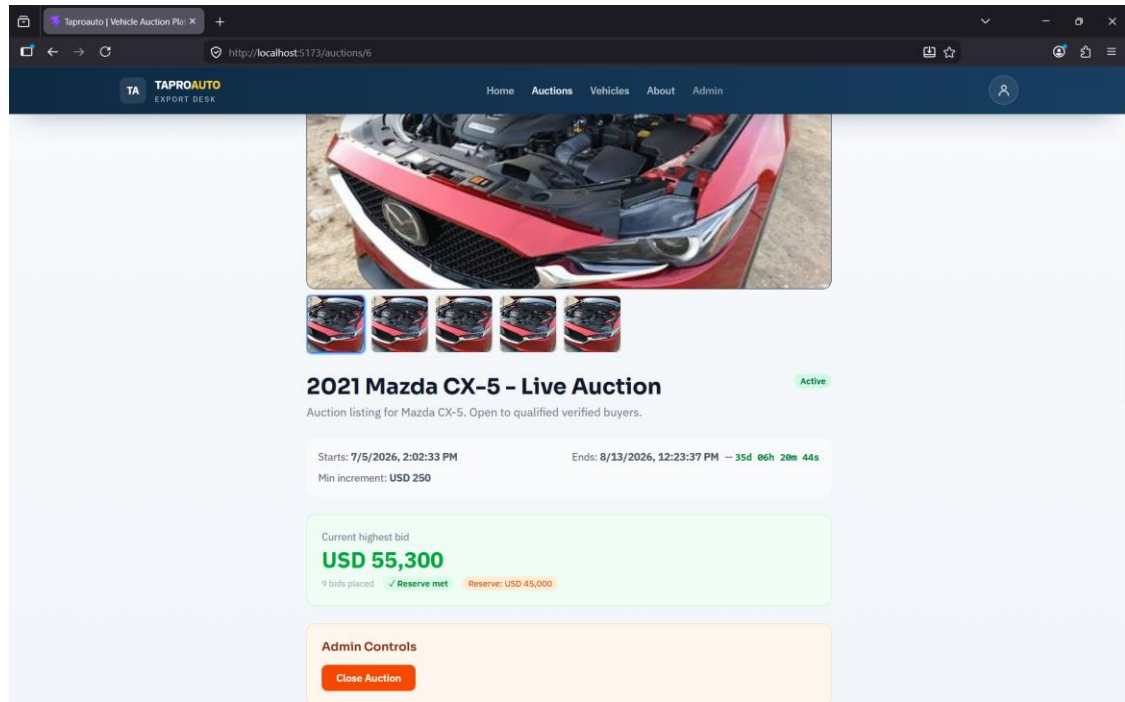
Below the form is a note: 'Bidding will show as "reserve not met" (red) until the highest bid exceeds this value. Buyers cannot see the amount.'

At the bottom of the form are two buttons: 'Create Auction' (blue) and 'Cancel' (white).

Two ways exist to end an auction:

- Automatically - the system checks every minute and moves an auction from Active to Ended once its end time has passed.
- Manually - click Close Auction on the auction detail page; this immediately ends the auction and assigns the current highest bid as the winner.

After closing, review the bid ladder and use Select Winner if you need to override the automatically assigned winner (for example, if the highest bid did not meet the reserve price).



5.4 Managing Users

The Users tab lists every registered buyer with their current verification status: Pending, Verified, or Rejected.

16. Locate the buyer awaiting verification (shown as Pending).
17. Click Verify to approve the account, or Reject to deny it.
18. The pending-count badge on the Admin navigation link updates immediately without a page reload.

ID	NAME	EMAIL	ROLE	STATUS	ACTIONS
34	Owner Two	owner2@thaproauto.com	Admin	Verified	
33	Owner	owner@thaproauto.com	Admin	Verified	
32	Kavindu Jehan	kavindukamil@gmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
22	Meghan Farrell	meghan.farrell.buyer022@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
6	Kobe Trade Cars	seller4@demo.example.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
26	Samantha Sporer	samantha.sporer.buyer026@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
4	Osaka Motor Depot	seller2@demo.example.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
18	Alejandro Nader	alejandro.nader.buyer018@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
13	Abe Hyatt	abe.hyatt.buyer013@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
16	Any Lubowitz	anya.lubowitz.buyer016@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
2	Tapro Manager	manager@demo.example.com	Admin	Verified	
27	Maurine Daugherty-Zulauf	maurine.daugherty_zulauf.buyer027@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
31	Abelardo Kuvalis	abelardo.kuvalis.buyer031@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject
17	Ada Ernser	ada.ernser.buyer017@auctionmail.com	Buyer	Verified	Reject

Note: A rejected buyer can be re-verified later if circumstances change; rejection is not permanent.

5.5 Reserve Price Visibility

Only administrators can see the exact reserve price figure on an auction. Buyers instead see a colour-coded indicator (no reserve, reserve not met, or reserve met) so pricing strategy stays confidential while bidders still know where they stand.

6. Account Security

6.1 Automatic Logout

For your security, you are automatically logged out after 30 minutes of inactivity. Any mouse movement, click, keystroke, or scroll resets this timer. If you are logged out, you will see a session-expired message on the Login page and can simply log in again.

6.2 Changing Your Password

Password changes are not yet self-service through the interface. Contact an administrator if you need your password reset.

7. Troubleshooting

Issue	What To Do
I cannot see the bid form on an active auction.	Confirm you are logged in and that your account has been verified by an administrator. Log out and log back in after verification.
My bid was rejected.	Your bid amount was below the current highest bid plus the minimum increment. Check the amounts shown on the auction page and try a higher bid.

Issue	What To Do
I was logged out unexpectedly.	Sessions expire after 30 minutes of inactivity for security. Simply log in again.
Images are not uploading on the vehicle form.	Check your internet connection and that the file is a supported image format (JPG or PNG). Try a smaller file if the upload times out.
The pending-users badge did not update.	Refresh the page. The badge updates automatically after a Verify or Reject action but requires the browser tab to remain open.

8. Support

For further assistance beyond this manual, contact the system administrator or the development team using the contact details provided separately by TaproJapan Co. Ltd.

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Home Auctions Vehicles About

Sign in Register

Reach us through any of the channels below. We respond to all enquiries within one business day.

OFFICE ADDRESS
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Tokyo 145-0064, Japan
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Subject

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